AAI101 Module 6 Discussion: No-Code vs Coding for AI

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1. Two no-code / low-code AI tools

Google Teachable Machine trains simple image, sound, or pose models in the browser. You do not write code. You add examples, press train, and test the result. The pro is speed. You can try an idea in minutes without setting up Python. The con is control. It is made for small demos, so you cannot change how the model is built, and it is a weak fit once the data gets large or the desired result is analysis of more complex situations.

Microsoft Power Apps is a low-code tool you can use to build an app from data you already have, like a list or a spreadsheet, and connect it to other Microsoft tools. The pro is that you can get a working screen up without a developer making every page. The con is that you are stuck inside Microsoft's setup. If you need a rule or a connection the builder does not have, you run out of options.

2. Real-world scenario

My current occupation is finance, and the scenario I picked is fraud in retirement accounts. A retirement account can show a withdrawal that does not match someone’s usual pattern, or a change to a bank account or contact info that looks wrong. I would start with a low-code solution that can flag cases for a person to review. That is faster to stand up, and the people checking retirement accounts are not all programmers, but human review can backstop a bad flag. I would not let the app freeze an account or decide fraud on its own. A wrong flag can lock someone out of their retirement money. If the company later needed custom fraud rules, an audit trail, or a tie-in to the main system that a no-code solution cannot handle, that is when I would move that part into code.

3. Three decision factors

Three factors would decide that choice. Time matters because a retirement team needs a working fraud check soon, not a months-long build, but it also needs to adapt as fraud techniques change. Technical expertise matters because the staff reviewing accounts may not write code, so the first tool has to be simple and backed up with human review. Customization matters because retirement fraud rules are specific to the account, the changes, the history, and the request. If the app cannot match how the company reviews a case, code is the safer path.

4. Reflection

I am taking this class with CIS 125 Intro to Programming, and I still think coding is worth it even with no-code tools. Some situations need a level of nuance that only a coded solution can provide. No-code is useful when the job is straightforward, or when a person can check it. Coding helps you see what the tool is doing and fix a miss that is too complex for it. It is important to know when coding fits the business need better. I would use both, but for different levels of detail. No-code can be an axe. Code is a scalpel.